

Maria Silva

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LLB and LLM graduate with hands-on experience supporting property and dispute matters at BCLP, Citizens Advice and in commercial legal settings. At BCLP's Real Estate Disputes team, supported the full lifecycle of property litigation matters: document management, electronic bundling, hearing preparation, and research on leasehold, landlord and tenant, and easement issues. Currently managing client matters end-to-end at Citizens Advice, including housing cases, with a consistent record of accurate file management, deadline discipline and clear client communication. Detail-driven, well organised, and motivated to develop within a residential conveyancing team.

EDUCATION

Law LLB — 2:1

Sept 2020 – June 2024

University College London

- Modules included Advanced Contract Law, Commercial Law, Alternative Dispute Resolution and Company Law
- Property and conveyancing law covered as part of core LLB curriculum

Comparative and International Dispute Resolution LLM — Merit

Sept 2024 – Oct 2025

Queen Mary University of London

- Dissertation: data protection and the development of GDPR across jurisdictions — Distinction (75%)
- Modules covering procedural law, legal research, evidence analysis and international dispute resolution

International Foundation Programme — Law and International Relations

Sept 2019 – June 2020

King's College London

- Awarded the Leaders of Tomorrow prize (top 20 of a 200-student cohort; partial funding toward undergraduate degree)

EXPERIENCE

Bryan Cave Leighton Paisner LLP (BCLP) · London

Feb 2024 – Aug 2024

Legal Placement Student — Real Estate Disputes

- Supported fee earners across residential and commercial property dispute matters, including leasehold issues, landlord and tenant disputes, rights of light and easements
- Prepared electronic hearing bundles and assisted with court materials and skeleton arguments
- Managed large volumes of confidential documents across several concurrent matters with competing deadlines
- Assisted with court filings, hearing arrangements, matter opening and closure, and deadline tracking
- Maintained structured matter records via iManage; supported cost comparisons and administrative matter management
- Conducted legal and factual research to support fee earners' advice to clients on property issues

Bryan Cave Leighton Paisner LLP (BCLP) · London

Aug 2023 – Feb 2024

Legal Placement Student — International Arbitration

- Supported a complex investment arbitration: reviewed and organised evidence, drafted procedural histories and procedural orders, and amended sections of the Claimant's memorial
- Became the primary junior supporting the team shortly before a significant deadline — coordinated documents, tracked outstanding actions and helped ensure on-time submission
- Maintained structured electronic case files and monitored procedural deadlines across the matter
- Liaised with the client regarding required documents; coordinated external translation work
- Received feedback from a partner and associate that performance was comparable to a newly qualified solicitor

Citizens Advice East Berkshire · Maidenhead**July 2026 – Present****Legal Adviser**

- Manages matters end-to-end across housing, welfare, employment, family, debt and consumer issues — from initial instruction through to submission
- Takes detailed factual instructions, establishes chronologies, identifies legal and evidential issues and advises clients on next steps and procedural requirements
- Drafts correspondence, prepares applications and document schedules, maintains confidential case records and meets deadlines consistently
- Translates complex legal and procedural rules into clear, practical guidance for clients, including those in vulnerable circumstances

Q-Legal · Remote**Oct 2024 – Jan 2025****Legal Adviser**

- Managed a data-privacy matter from client instruction through to a formal written advice letter, under a qualified solicitor's supervision
- Researched UK GDPR and Data Protection Act 2018 obligations; translated complex statutory requirements into clear, commercially focused advice
- Coordinated with client and supervising solicitor to meet the agreed deadline

Adobe · London**June 2022 – Aug 2022****Legal Intern**

- Reviewed and amended software licensing agreements; identified contractual risks and assessed alignment with internal legal and compliance requirements
- Reviewed confidentiality and data-processing provisions; researched UK GDPR, EU GDPR and cross-border transfer obligations
- Liaised with sales, legal and international business teams to resolve contractual queries and reconcile commercial objectives with legal risk
- Prepared and delivered an internal presentation on breach-of-contract risks and mitigation measures

SKILLS

Languages: Portuguese (native), English (fluent), Spanish (basic)

Technical skills: iManage; electronic court filing portals; electronic bundling; document review and management; legal and factual research; Microsoft Word, Excel and PowerPoint; case management and time-recording systems; concise report and correspondence writing

Case and evidence management: Hearing bundle preparation, matter file organisation, deadline tracking, procedural document drafting, confidential document management across concurrent matters